

Linux guiding our vision of transforming the automobile industry," says Agarwal.

Low on cost

Open source technology was also easy on the pocket for Carnation. A large portion of the cost savings resulted from the elimination of exaggerated software licensing fees. "Our estimates show that cost benefits are likely to exceed 50 per cent compared to proprietary platforms," said Agarwal.

Further, Carnation hopes to achieve a lower total cost of ownership through open source because security is inherent to the platform (and not additional licensing baggage), aided by quick deployment that is crucial for a business where time is money. "We are looking at over 30 per cent cost savings from IT investments in Red Hat solutions over the next five years," says Agarwal.

Many critics, however, might claim that maintenance costs of an open source platform might squash these dreams. But Carnation's experience of a customer facing an enterprise system on the Linux platform speaks otherwise.

"By opting for Tata Consultancy Services (TCS) to provide end-to-end system integration services through a multi-year agreement for an enterprise IT solution, we ensured no hitches in the maintenance of our IT system. We have raised a couple of tickets but there have been no major hitches so far," says Agarwal.

Additionally, RHEL Advanced Platform with integrated virtualisation enabled Carnation to quickly virtualise servers for testing and development, and try new features in-house before deploying them on customer-facing applications. "The open source platform allowed us to increase the utilisation of servers without increasing the number of servers to be deployed. Red Hat came with the ability to move within virtual machines, on-the-fly, without any performance deterioration," says Agarwal.

"The compatibility of SAP with Red Hat, and Red Hat with the HP servers, worked very well for us. It helped meet the increasing demands of the business, enhanced process efficiencies, and led to rapid growth," he adds.

The road ahead!

Looking ahead, Carnation hopes to deploy open source on its existing desktops. "We have about 20 desktops per hub. We are looking at an open source desktop platform in these hubs in about a year. We are looking at tremendous cost savings, and the easy management of front-end users' systems, which are like points of sale," quips Agarwal.

It sure is life on the fast lane for Carnation! 

By: **Vanisha Joseph**

The author loves to experiment and writing for LINUX For You is her latest experiment. So, beware! Just a minute, she also happens to be a journalist during the day.

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